

Curriculum Vitae

Shaolin Pu

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EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in *Analytics, Information and Operations*, University of Kansas, Expected May 2027
Committee: Ben Sherwood (Co-Chair), Karthik Srinivasan (Co-Chair), Arvind Tripathi, Suman Mallik, and Yexin Jessica Li
Dissertation: “Essays on Project Creator Strategies in Reward-Based Crowdfunding”
- M.S. in *Business Analytics and Information Systems*, University of South Florida
- M.S. in *Management*, University of South Florida
- B.S. in *Systems Science and Engineering*, University of Shanghai for Science and Technology, Shanghai, China

RESEARCH

Research Interests

Topics: Digital Economy; Artificial Intelligence; Digital Platforms; Crowdfunding and Sharing Economy.

Methodologies: Econometrics, Experimental Design, Machine Learning, Data Mining, Analytical Modeling.

Dissertation

The dissertation, titled “*Essays on Project Creator Strategies in Reward-Based Crowdfunding*”, consists of three essays. Defense expected Spring 2027.

1. “*When Individuals Compete with Organizations: Messaging Strategies and Funding Outcomes in Reward-Based Crowdfunding*” with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
 - Presented at the Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIIS 2022) and the International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS 2023).

Abstract: Drawing on signaling theory, this study examines how informational and emotional messaging affect crowdfunding performance for individual versus organizational creators. Analyzing 17,662 Kickstarter campaigns with survey-validated text measures built via natural language processing (NLP) and large language models (LLMs), the results show that informational messaging is more effective for organizational creators

while emotional messaging is more rewarded for individual creators, suggesting that effective communication requires aligning message emphasis with creator type.

2. “*Spillover or Starvation? Effects of Blockbuster Projects in Reward-Based Crowdfunding*” with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
 - Presented at 2024 AMA Summer Academic Conference, 2025 Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium.

Abstract: Drawing on cross-side network effects and category legitimization arguments, this study examines whether blockbuster projects monopolize backer resources or expand the market on crowdfunding platforms. Using a stacked difference-in-differences (DiD) design on 128,757 Kickstarter projects covering 103 blockbuster events, the results show that blockbuster emergence increases project launches, backer counts, and pledged amounts in the same category, especially among first-time creators.

3. “*Riding the Wave, Dodging the Crowd: How Competing Goals Shape Launch Timing in Reward-Based Crowdfunding*” with Ben Sherwood, Karthik Srinivasan, and Arvind Tripathi.
 - Presented at 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2026 HICSS Doctoral Fellows Program and Doctoral Consortium, 2026 POMS Annual Conference.

Abstract: This study examines how competitive pressure shapes creators' launch timing on crowdfunding platforms across two goals: raising brand awareness versus maximizing pledged amounts. Analyzing day-level launch behavior across 184,537 Kickstarter projects, the results show that creators launch alongside mega competitors to gain visibility but avoid intense competition to protect funding, and that such avoidance increases pledged amounts.

Refereed Conference Publications

1. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. “How High-Profile Projects Shape Creator Influx on Reward-Based Crowdfunding Platforms.” *Proceedings of 2025 Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium*, Nashville, Tennessee (December 2025).
2. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. “Should Creators Delay Their Project Launches? Analyzing the Blockbuster Effect on Reward-Based Crowdfunding.” *Proceedings of 2024 AMA Summer Academic Conference*, Boston, Massachusetts (August 2024).
3. **Pu, S.,** Srinivasan, K., Sherwood, B., & Tripathi, A. “Does Narrative Impact Funding? Analyzing the Relationship Between Project Description and Pledged Amounts for Reward-Based Crowdfunding Projects.” *Proceedings of 44th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*, Hyderabad, India (December 2023).

4. **Pu, S., & Srinivasan, K.** “Are Project Narrative Attributes Indicative of Pre-Order Campaign Success on Crowdfunding Platforms? A Text-Mining Approach.” *Proceedings of 17th Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIS)*, Omaha, Nebraska (May 2022).

Conference and Workshop Presentations

1. “When Does Crowdfunding Outperform Amazon Launchpad? A Comparative Analysis Using Newsvendor and (Q,R) Inventory Models.” *2026 DSI Annual Conference, San Francisco, California* (Scheduled November 2026).
2. “When Individuals Compete with Organizations: Messaging Strategies and Funding Outcomes in Reward-Based Crowdfunding.” *2026 DSI Annual Conference, San Francisco, California* (Scheduled November 2026).
3. “Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: How Competition Shapes Launch Decisions Across Creator Types.” *2026 POMS Annual Conference, Reno, Nevada* (May 2026).
4. “Where Should Creators Launch? A Newsvendor Approach to Crowdfunding and E-Commerce Platform Selection.” *2026 POMS Annual Conference, Reno, Nevada* (May 2026).
5. “Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: Effect of Competition on Project Launch Decisions.” *The Eighth Doctoral Fellows Program and Doctoral Consortium, 59th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS), Maui, Hawaii* (January 2026).
6. “How High-Profile Projects Shape Creator Influx on Reward-Based Crowdfunding Platforms.” *2025 Pre-ICIS SIGDSA Symposium, Nashville, Tennessee* (December 2025).
7. “Strategic Timing in Crowdfunding: Effect of Competition on Project Launch Decisions.” *2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, Georgia* (October 2025).
8. “Should Creators Delay Their Project Launches? Analyzing the Blockbuster Effect on Reward-Based Crowdfunding.” *2024 AMA Summer Academic Conference, Boston, Massachusetts* (August 2024).
9. “Does Narrative Impact Funding? Analyzing the Relationship Between Project Description and Pledged Amounts for Reward-Based Crowdfunding Projects.” *44th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Hyderabad, India* (December 2023).
10. “Are Project Narrative Attributes Indicative of Pre-Order Campaign Success on Crowdfunding Platforms? A Text-Mining Approach.” *17th Midwest Association for Information Systems Conference (MWAIS), Omaha, Nebraska* (May 2022).

TEACHING

Teaching Interests

Information Systems; Business Analytics; Data Analysis and Forecasting; Text Mining; Digital Economy; Machine Learning; Deep Learning; Database Management; Programming (Python, R, C, and C++); and Artificial Intelligence

and Agentic AI (focusing on their technical and strategic dimensions, business applications and risks, and impact on digital platform markets).

Teaching Experience

Instructor – University of Kansas, School of Business

- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (30 Students, Teaching Evaluations: 4.63/5, Fall 2025)
- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (29 Students, Teaching Evaluations: 4.15/5, Fall 2024)

Graduate Teaching Assistant – University of Kansas, School of Business

- BSAN 440 – Foundations in Business Analytics, (Spring 2026, Spring 2025, Fall 2022)
- BSAN 416 – Modeling and Optimization of Business Decisions, (Fall 2026)
- BSAN/SCM 415 – Data Analysis and Forecasting, (Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Spring 2022)
- SCM 403 – Logistics, Transportation, and Warehouse Management, (Spring 2023)
- BSAN 326 – Database Management Systems, (Fall 2021)

Notes: The BSAN and SCM courses listed above are undergraduate offerings within the Business Analytics and Supply Chain Management programs, respectively.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- HICSS Doctoral Fellow, Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS), 2026
- John O. Tollefson Doctoral Student Teaching Award, University of Kansas, 2026
- Max E. Fessler Dissertation Award, University of Kansas, 2025

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee for Journals

- Journal of Business Analytics (JBA), 2026
- Management Science Reproducibility Project (ManSciReP), 2023

Referee for Conferences

- International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2026
- International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2025
- International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2024

REFERENCES

Available upon request.